

Scrapbook Embellishment Categories Guide

A large-print resource for Scrapbooking with Grandma

Find the little pieces that help tell your story. This guide includes 16 categories, cardstock cutting ideas, Print Then Cut ideas, and a simple way to build clusters around your photos.

Using this guide

Choose a category that matches your memory. Pick a few pieces, repeat colors from your photos, and leave space for journaling. Some pieces fit more than one category.

Before you make your pieces

Cricut cutting: The ideas use simple shapes suitable for cardstock. Keep delicate details large enough to cut and handle comfortably.

Print-and-Cut: Print Then Cut prints a design and cuts its outline. Use a compatible Cricut machine and suitable printable material. Follow your machine's instructions.

Printing this guide: Use US Letter paper, portrait orientation, and actual size. Color accents are optional; the dark text also reads well in grayscale.

1 Basic Shapes

Examples: Circles, squares, stars, hearts, arrows, scallops, frames, and tabs.

Cricut idea: Cut simple shapes from cardstock in several sizes. Stack a small heart on a larger circle.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print patterned stars, hearts, or arrows, then cut around each design.

Try it: Repeat one shape in three spots to connect your page.

2 Labels & Journaling

Examples: Tags, tickets, labels, banners, speech bubbles, and journaling cards.

Cricut idea: Cut tags with holes and layered label shapes. Add handwriting after cutting.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print labels with dates or short prompts, leaving room for your memories.

Try it: Tuck a tag beside a photo so the story stays easy to find.

3 Florals & Nature

Examples: Flowers, leaves, vines, trees, branches, butterflies, and mushrooms.

Cricut idea: Cut layered petals and leaf silhouettes from coordinating cardstock.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print floral illustrations or butterflies with a simple outline for cutting.

Try it: Place a large flower with two smaller leaves for a quick cluster.

4 People & Family

Examples: Babies, children, grandparents, family figures, and silhouettes.

Cricut idea: Cut simple people silhouettes or a family-themed frame.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print illustrated family characters or small name labels.

Try it: Choose pieces that reflect the people and relationships in your photos.

5 Animals & Pets

Examples: Cats, dogs, birds, farm animals, and woodland animals.

Cricut idea: Cut paw prints, bones, animal silhouettes, or layered animal faces.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print pet illustrations or a small label with your pet's name.

Try it: Pair an animal piece with a heart and a journaling tag.

6 Celebrations

Examples: Birthdays, weddings, anniversaries, graduations, and parties.

Cricut idea: Cut balloons, cakes, candles, graduation caps, or confetti shapes.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print party icons, milestone numbers, or celebration labels.

Try it: Use a number or date as the main piece in your cluster.

7 Holidays & Seasons

Examples: Christmas, Halloween, Easter, fall, winter, spring, and summer.

Cricut idea: Cut ornaments, pumpkins, eggs, snowflakes, leaves, or suns.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print seasonal illustrations and holiday word strips.

Try it: Repeat two or three seasonal colors for a coordinated page.

8 Travel & Adventure

Examples: Cars, planes, maps, suitcases, road signs, and compasses.

Cricut idea: Cut suitcase shapes, arrows, map pins, or vehicle silhouettes.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print destination labels, travel tickets, or miniature map pieces.

Try it: Place a map pin near the photo of the place you visited.

9 School & Kids

Examples: Buses, pencils, books, backpacks, crayons, and playground pieces.

Cricut idea: Cut pencils, apples, school buses, or simple book shapes.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print grade labels, school-year tags, or illustrated supplies.

Try it: Leave room for the child's age, grade, and a favorite memory.

10 Sports & Activities

Examples: Baseball, football, bikes, scooters, dance, and swimming.

Cricut idea: Cut balls, stars, trophies, bikes, or activity silhouettes.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print team-color labels, score tags, or activity illustrations.

Try it: Use an arrow or curved arrangement to suggest movement.

11 Home & Everyday Life

Examples: Houses, food, cooking, gardening, and shopping.

Cricut idea: Cut houses, cups, utensils, watering cans, or shopping bags.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print recipe labels, garden illustrations, or everyday word strips.

Try it: Celebrate small moments such as baking together or planting flowers.

12 Memory & Sentiment

Examples: Hearts, cameras, photo frames, keepsake symbols, and meaningful dates.

Cricut idea: Cut hearts, camera shapes, or frames sized for your photos.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print memory labels or short sentiments such as “Remember this.”

Try it: Choose one piece that helps explain why the memory matters.

13 Decorative Pieces

Examples: Bows, ribbons, lace, doilies, buttons, charms, and rosettes.

Cricut idea: Cut paper bows, doily shapes, or strips for folded rosettes.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print lace patterns, button illustrations, or ribbon designs.

Try it: Use real ribbon or a flat paper version to suit your album.

14 Background & Layering Pieces

Examples: Torn strips, photo mats, circles, tags, banners, and borders.

Cricut idea: Cut photo mats, scalloped borders, or large shapes for a base.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print textured strips or patterned layering pieces.

Try it: Let a little of each layer show; keep the photo as the focus.

15 Titles & Words

Examples: Alphabet pieces, phrases, dates, names, and word strips.

Cricut idea: Cut bold letters or short words large enough to handle easily.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print phrases, names, or dates on strips with generous margins.

Try it: Keep titles readable and place them where they guide the eye.

16 Embellishment Clusters

Examples: Ready-made groups of three to five coordinating pieces.

Cricut idea: Cut a base circle, a main shape, and two small accents.

Print-and-Cut idea: Print a coordinated set of icons, labels, and word strips.

Try it: Combine one large piece, one medium piece, and one small piece.

How to Build a Cluster

A cluster is a small group of pieces arranged together. Start with three pieces, then add only what helps your photo and story.

1 Start with a group of three

Choose one main embellishment and two supporting pieces. A flower, leaf, and tag make an easy starting group.

2 Vary the sizes

Use one large piece, one medium piece, and one small piece. Let the largest piece be the anchor.

3 Build the layers

Set down a flat base such as a circle or tag. Overlap the main piece and tuck an accent partly behind it. Keep some of every piece visible.

4 Repeat colors and shapes

Choose two or three colors from your photo or papers. Repeat a heart, circle, or flower elsewhere on the page to help everything feel connected.

5 Balance around your photos

Place the main cluster near a photo corner. Add a smaller related cluster on the opposite side if the page needs balance. Keep faces and important details clear.

Try These Simple Clusters

Family memory

Large photo-frame corner + medium heart + small name tag. Repeat the heart near your journaling.

Garden day

Large flower + medium leaf + small butterfly. Tuck the leaf under the flower and angle the butterfly toward the photo.

Birthday celebration

Large balloon + medium number + small star. Use the same colors in a smaller cluster beside the title.

Before You Glue

Arrange everything loosely first. Step back and check that the photo catches your eye, the title is readable, and the cluster does not cover your story.

Use flat adhesive for a slimmer album. Add foam adhesive sparingly when you want dimension. Choose photo-safe supplies for pieces that touch your photos.

Leave a little open space. A finished page does not need an embellishment in every corner. Three well-chosen pieces can be enough.